

Table of contents

1 1. Getting Familiar with RStudio

When you open RStudio, you will see several panels. Each panel has a different job.

At first, the screen may look busy. That is normal. You do not need to understand everything right away.

1.1 The RStudio Interface

RStudio usually has four main areas:

1. **Source Pane**
2. **Console**
3. **Environment Pane**
4. **Files / Plots / Packages / Help Pane**

[Insert Screenshot: RStudio Interface]

Add a labeled screenshot showing the Source Pane, Console, Environment Pane, and Files/Plots/Packages/Help Pane.

1.2 Source Pane

The **Source Pane** is where you write and save code.

You will usually write your code in a file called an **R script**. R scripts end with **.R**.

Example file name:

```
first_script.R
```

The Source Pane is useful because it lets you save your work and come back to it later.

 **Tip**

The Source Pane is like a notebook for your code.

1.3 Console

The **Console** is where R runs commands.

You can type code directly into the Console and press Enter.

For example:

```
2 + 2
```

R will show the answer:

```
[1] 4
```

The Console is useful for quick tests, but you usually should save important code in an R script.

Common Mistake

Do not only type important work into the Console. If you close RStudio, that code may be hard to find later.

Use an R script to save your work.

1.4 Environment Pane

The **Environment Pane** shows objects you have created.

An object is something stored in R, such as a number, a word, or a dataset.

For example, if you run:

```
score <- 95
```

You should see `score` appear in the Environment Pane.

1.5 Files / Plots / Packages / Help Pane

This pane has several useful tabs.

1.5.1 Files

The **Files** tab shows folders and files on your computer.

You can use it to find your project folder and open files.

1.5.2 Plots

The **Plots** tab shows graphs that you create in R.

1.5.3 Packages

The **Packages** tab shows extra R tools that are installed.

A package is like an add-on for R.

1.5.4 Help

The **Help** tab lets you search for information about R commands.

For example, you can search for help about the `mean()` function.

1.6 Try It Yourself

Practice

Open RStudio and try the following:

1. Find the Console.
2. Type this command:

```
10 + 5
```

3. Press Enter.
4. Look for the answer.
5. Find the Environment Pane.
6. Find the Files tab.

1.7 Check Your Understanding

Answer these questions in your own words:

1. Where do you write and save code?
2. Where does R show the results of commands?
3. Where can you see objects you created?
4. Where do plots appear?

1.8 Summary

In this section, you learned that RStudio has several main panes:

- The **Source Pane** is where you write and save code.
- The **Console** is where code runs and results appear.
- The **Environment Pane** shows objects you created.
- The **Files / Plots / Packages / Help Pane** helps you manage files, view graphs, use packages, and get help.